

Welcome to the Huyck Preserve Trail System! The Huyck Preserve contains a network of over twelve miles of trails which go through a wide variety of habitats, including old growth hemlock forest, freshwater wetland, shrub swamps, second-growth hardwood forest, and pine plantations. When hiking our trails we encourage hikers to bring water and snacks, wear appropriate clothing and footwear, and plan their excursions keeping in mind hiking ability and time. Trails at the Huyck Preserve are open to the public dawn to dusk.

In case of emergency please call:
Adam Caprio, Buildings and Ground Supervisor, 518-813-6472
Dawn O'Neal, Executive Director, 518-813-5583
General DEC Emergency Number:

Lincoln Pond Trail
This trail begins near the Eldridge Research Station at the south end of Lincoln Pond across the bridge over Lincoln Pond Dam. The trail starts out passing through mixed deciduous forest before the trail narrows following closely the edge of the Pond. Continuing on, the trail opens up again hopping over a gentle stream as it passes through a 200 year old hemlock forest. The trail crosses two bridges connected by a span of boardwalk over a wetlands in which abundant beaver activity is evident before turning back into the forest to head gently uphill before depositing hikers at the back of Bullfrog Camp at the Biological Research Station. Continue down the grassy hill pass Horse Cabin to Bullfrog Camp Lane which will lead you back to the Eldridge Research Center and Pond Hill Rd. Look out for red squirrels, fishers, eastern newts and giant ostrich ferns as you traverse this trail. A wide variety of birdlife including warblers, waterfowl and bald eagles are frequently seen in and around the pond.

Total Distance: 0.6 miles
Difficulty: Even with slightly uneven terrain this is the easiest trail in the Huyck Preserve trail system and one that visitors of all ages have enjoyed.



Trail Map

Huyck Preserve and Biological Research Station

PO Box 189
Rensselaerville, NY 12147
Main Office Tel/Fax: 518-797-3440
Eldridge Research Center
Tel: 518-797-5172

www.huyckpreserve.org

Rensselaerville Falls Trail
This trail begins near the Visitor Center at the edge of the historic village of Rensselaerville. Walk straight back from the steps of the Visitors Center, across the parking lot, to find the trail head marked by a kiosk. The trail is wheelchair accessible and ADA compliant as it follows along 10 Mile Creek to the lower falls bridge at the base of the breathtaking Rensselaerville Falls. Look out for the ruins of the Huyck Felt Mill near the bottom of the falls just over the lower bridge. The trail then veers away from the falls to make a somewhat steep climb to the head of the Falls, snaking through mixed deciduous forest and past one of the Preserve's many Pine plantations. Taking a left midway up the climb will lead you the Hilltown Café and Post Office. Continuing up the hill, the trail flattens out as you veer to the right crossing over the remains of a stone wall that once marked a property boundary. A short walk finds you at the top of the falls which you can see if you peak through the trees, following the stairs that appear just to your right will put you at the top of the Falls. A jaunt across the upper falls bridge brings you to the Falls Overlook. The trail can then be followed to the shores of Lake Myosotis by retracing your steps back across the bridge and making a right at the top of the steps or continuing straight from the overlook where the trail continues to the Lake Myosotis trail loop on your left.

Total Distance: 1 mile to and from Falls Overlook.
Difficulty: There is a significant, but short, climb at the beginning of the trail making this trail Moderate to Difficult

Lake Myosotis Trail
This trail passes through northern hardwood forests and wetlands rich with wildlife and wildflowers as it circumvents Lake Myosotis. The trail can be picked up off of the Falls Trail, Lake Myosotis Beach (open during the summer), or at the trail head located off Pond Hill Rd. across from the Eldridge Research Center. If starting at the trail head, park in the lot next to the kiosk across from the Research Center for ease of access. From this location you can either start at the kiosk to Lake Trail West, or hike up the road ~0.1 miles to the Lake Trail East trailhead on your right.

From Lake Trail West continue across the small bridge

taking a moment to tap out a tune on the PVC scale. The trail follows a gentle rise as it heads towards the lake before taking slight right turn to meander through a low lying wetland and heading uphill. The trail crosses another small stream before turning downhill towards the lake. This cooler and shaded side of the lake lends itself towards a few wet spots here and there during early spring and late fall so be sure to wear sturdy shoes. Lake Trail West continues along slightly uneven terrain thanks to hemlock and other tree roots poking up along the trail before heading down hill and to the right to a stream crossing. A gentle rise will bring you back into mixed deciduous forest and a fork to your left will lead you to the top of the spillway for Lake Myosotis Dam. There is no thru access to the other side of the trail from the spillway but this is a nice place to grab a picnic lunch as you look over Lake Myosotis. Backtracking, puts you on the Lake Trail which continues on to the top of the Rensselaerville Falls. Take a left and head down the stairs to cross the Upper Falls Bridge. Take a moment to enjoy the falls from the Overlook before continuing on. The trail takes another turn, this time to the left as you re-enter the forest and head up hill into one of the many Pine Plantations dotting the Preserve's landscape. The Lake Trail East is considerably flatter making for a nice stroll to Lake Myosotis Beach. Follow the trail signs past the beach and the boat racks and a small pine stand on your left. The trail opens up a bit before diving into a shrubby habitat filled with numerous warblers during spring and summer. You will pass Ordway Trail on your left, marking the midway point between the trail end and the beach. Lake Trail East continues into one of the prettiest and most diverse habitats of the Preserve before forking to the left (heading right connects you with Wheeler Watson Trail) and making a gentle climb towards Pond Hill Rd. Hang a left at the road to return to the Eldridge Research Center parking area.

Total Distance: ~3 miles
Difficulty: Lake Trail East can be considered Moderate to Easy while Lake Trail West, due to roots, wet spots, and a few uphill portions is more Moderate.

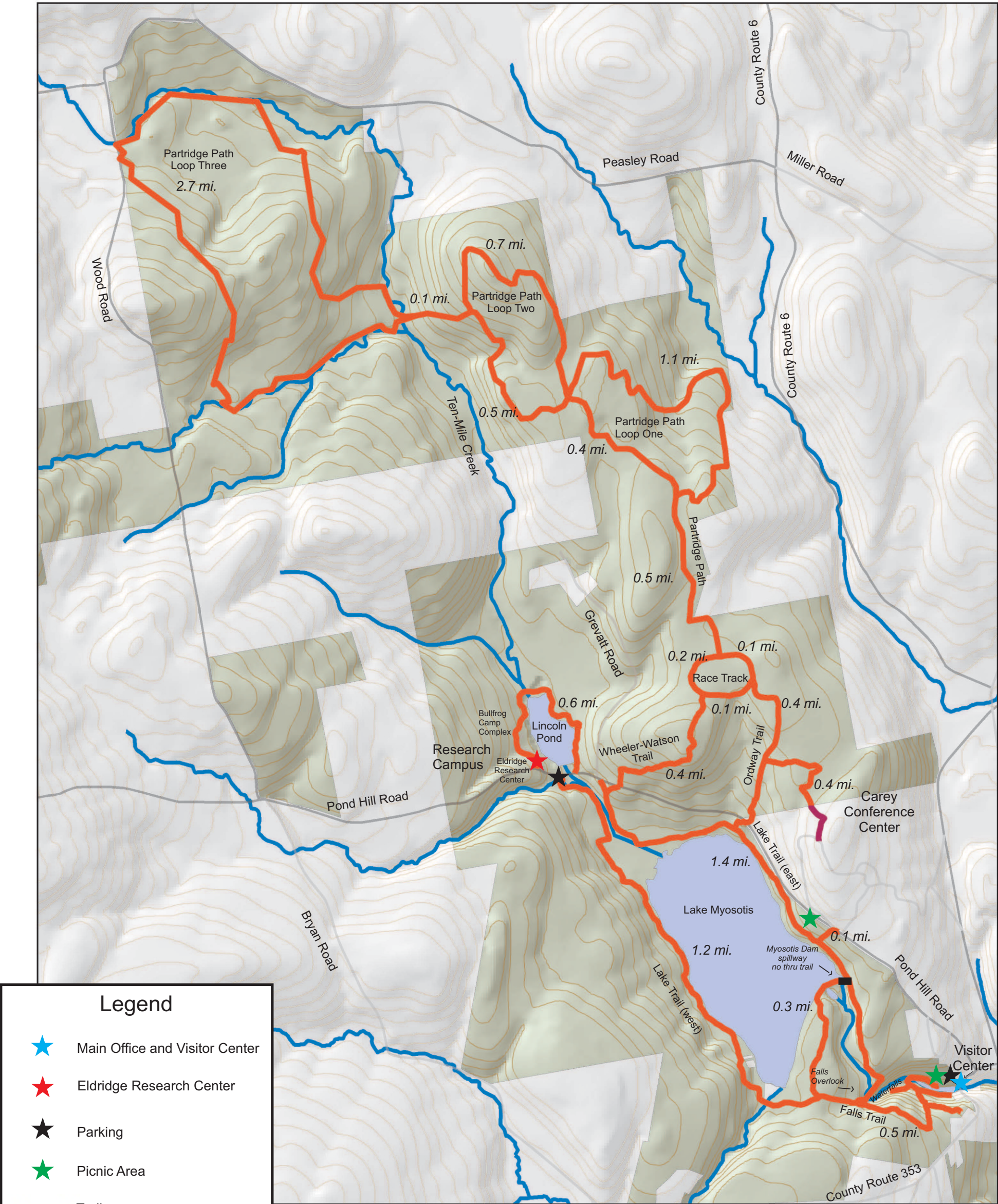
Wheeler-Watson, Race Track and Ordway Trails
Wheeler-Watson and Ordway trails mostly act as connector trails between Lake Myosotis Trail and the Race Track which leads to Partridge Path. The Wheeler-Watson trail begins off of Pond Hill Rd. near the Eldridge Research Station parking area, approximately 0.1 miles up the road on the left. From the road, the trail climbs uphill for 0.4 miles meandering through second-growth hardwood forest and thickets in which the Preserve's rich human history can be observed in old apple trees, stone walls, and in the historic Wheeler-Watson cemetery, where many of the early settlers of Rensselaerville find their resting place. The trail ends at the Race Track, where Sunday horse races were once held making it a great place for cross-country skiing and a nice breather after Wheeler-Watson. Taking a left from Wheeler-Watson trail on to Race Track, the trail loops around one of the oldest Pine Plantations on the Preserve and serves as the entrance to Partridge Path Trail system. Alternatively, you can pick up Ordway Trail which appears on your right. Ordway Trail fades from mixed pine forest into a shrubby, grassy field before heading downhill towards Pond Hill Rd. Be sure to keep an eye open for the ruffed grouse and deer in this part of the Preserve. Watch your step has you pass over a slightly rocky and occasionally damp trail before arriving at the road. A right will take you back to the parking area at the Eldridge Research Center or you can cross the road and head downhill to Lake Trail East.

Total Distance: ~1.5 miles
Difficulty: Uphill climbs on Wheeler-Watson and Ordway Trails and slightly uneven terrain make these trails Moderate to Difficult. Race Track's flat and wide surface make it ideal of cross country skiing and an Easy trail to walk.



Trail Map

Huyck Preserve and Biological Research Station



Legend

- ★ Main Office and Visitor Center
- ★ Eldridge Research Center
- ★ Parking
- ★ Picnic Area
- Trail

- Non-Preserve Trail
- Road
- Lake or Pond
- Stream
- Contour Lines (20 ft.)
- Huyck Preserve Land

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Huyck Preserve Rules and Trail Etiquette

In order to keep our trails pristine and our research areas undisturbed, we ask that you respect the following:

- Please keep pets on a leash.
 - Please stay on the trails.
 - Horses, bicycles, and motorized vehicles prohibited.
 - No hunting or trapping.
- Fishing allowed in Lake Myosotis only.
 - Camping and fires prohibited.
 - Take only pictures, leave only footprints.
 - Trails open dawn to dusk.

COM.EN.ART Illustrations: Cover: Trail Marker, Wade Neumeister, 1997; Mushrooms, Manabu Saito, 1996; Grapevineat Lake Myosotis, Robin Brickman, 2010; Map side: Astor sketch, Cris Winters, 2010.